Week 9 / Thursday

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Global vs. Local Concerns



Figure: Photo by Joshua Rawson-Harris on Unsplash

Reverse Outlining

A process of reviewing and assessing the structure of a draft to identify areas that could be revised/refined.

Reverse Outlining: Step 1

Read through your existing draft. As you do leave a comment for each paragraph that identifies the larger topic of the paragraph.

Reverse Outlining: Step 2

Now that you've read through the essay once, take a moment to write an answer to the following question: "What is the larger point or perspective I want to offer about my genre?" You can include your answer on a separate document or at the top of the draft.

Reverse Outlining: Step 3

Read through your paper one more time. This time, leave a second comment for each paragraph that answers the following two questions:

- What information is included in this paragraph that supports the larger perspective I identified in the last step?
- What additional information could be incldued in this paragraph to support that perspective?

Reverse Outlining: Step 4

Now, pick a single paragraph in your essay that you feel like could use some extra attention. For each sentence, leave a comment explaining what value it offers to the paragraph. Examples might include:

- "This sentence introduces the topic."
- "This sentence follows up on a quote to show how I'm thinking about it."

As you do this, take notes on how the paragraph could be improved.

Reverse Outlining: Reflection

Finally, take a few minutes to review the processes you've carried out and the notes you've taken. As you do so, try to identify some important areas of revision.